Naked Mole Rat Gets Dressed

By Mo Willems

NARRATOR: There is so much to learn about the fascinating little creatures known as naked mole rats. But for this story you only need to know three things: 1) They are a little bit rat. 2) They are a little bit mole. 3) They are ALL naked. Well, they ***were***, with one exception . . .

INTRODUCTION

I believe that we are NOT all meant to be the same; look the same, think the same. There is no one right way to show up in the world. Our individual, unique, varied expressions of life are beautiful.

George Bernard Shaw once said: "There are those that look at things the way they are, and ask why? I dream of things that never were, and ask why not?

Why not? Why not, indeed? Do clothes hurt anyone? In the infamous words of RuPaul: "We're all born naked and the rest is . . ."

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NARRATOR: Wilbur the naked mole rat who liked to get dressed. *(Wilbur inspects his attire in a large floor length mirror and adjusts his tie)* When the other naked mole rats saw him, they said:

MOLE RAT 1: Eeeeeeewwww!

MOLE RAT 2: Yuck!

MOLE RAT 3: What are you doing?

WILBUR: I like clothes. When I get dressed, I can be . . . fancy, or funny, or cool, or I can just be an astronaut. *(Wilbur assumes the demeanor of each description)*

NARRATOR: When the others heard that, they said:

MOLE RAT 1: Eeeeeewwww!

MOLE RAT 2: Yuck!

MOLE RAT 3: If you like clothes so much, then why don't you open a store or something?!

NARRATOR: Naked mole rats can be very sarcastic . . . But Wilbur thought that was a great idea. *(Wilbur pantomimes opening a glorious clothing store and showing off his wares to all the mole rats)* The other naked mole rats did not. *(Grumbling, they haul Wilbur away from the store)* They brought Wilbur to a giant portrait of Grand-pah, the oldest, greatest and most naked naked mole rate ever. *(assume a stately pose that would be hilarious if naked)*

MOLE RAT 1: Look at that picture!

MOLE RAT 2: Look at his heroic face!

MOLE RAT 3: Look at his regal bearing!

MOLE RAT 4: Look at his total lack of clothing!

WILBUR: *(to audience)* Grand-pah did look heroic. Grand-pah did look regal. *(to the other mole rats)* But he would also look heroic and regal in a casual shirt and some summer slacks.

MOLE RAT 1: Ugh! Don't you get it?

MOLE RAT 2: NAKED MOLE RATS DON'T WEAR CLOTHES!

WILBUR: Why not?

NARRATOR: ***Something*** had to be done. The naked mole rats marched right over to Grand-pah and told him all about Wilbur.

MOLE RAT 3: And then he asked "Why not?!"

NARRATOR: Grand-pah was very wise. *(Grand-pah thinks and thinks)* He thought seriously about everything he had heard. *(Grand-pah hmmms and hahhhhss)* Then he thought some more.

GRAND-PAH: *(in a heroic, regal voice)* Gather the colony! I shall make a proclamation!

MOLE RAT 1: *(excited)* A proclamation!

MOLE RAT 2: *(racing to tell everyone)* A proclamation!

MOLE RAT 3: *(in utter awe)* A proclamation!

NARRATOR: When Wilbur heard about Grand-pah's proclamation, he knew it was serious. But he had no idea what to wear. *(Wilbur begins trying on different outfits, hats, ties, jackets.*

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shoes) In the end, Wilbur decided to play it safe. *(Wilbur takes off all his clothes except for his socks)*

(The mole rats are fixated on Wilbur's socks, whispering and pointing – they are not happy) The others were so busy looking at Wilbur's socks that no one noticed Grand-pah enter, until he cleared his throat and proclaimed . . .

GRAND-PAH: *(clearing his throat, adjusting his jacket, hat and tie)* Fellow naked mole rats! I had never worn clothes until I heard Wilbur's simple question: Why not? Why not, indeed? Do clothes hurt anyone? No. Are they fun? Well, they may not be for everyone, but this old naked mole rate wishes he had tried getting dressed earlier!

NARRATOR: Then Grand-pah complimented Wilbur on his socks. As fast as his legs could take him, Wilbur rushed home, put on his favorite outfit and dashed back! *(actor pantomimes as narrator speaks)* When he returned, Wilbur discovered he was not alone.

MOLE RAT 1: *(curtsy's in a party dress)*

MOLE RAT 2: *(puts on some sunglasses and begins to moonwalk)*

MOLE RAT 3: *(crosses arms and refuses to join in the with the "dressed")*

MOLE RAT 4: *(pops an eye patch into place and draws a sword)* [ARGH!]

NARRATOR: Much has been said about that day, but for this story, you only need to know three things: 1) Some of the mole rats were naked. 2) Some of the mole rats were clothed. 3) All of the mole rats had a great time. No exceptions!

WILBUR: Why not?

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